"The first thing I explored was possible silhouettes, the most visual aspect of a flying wing since the profile is minimal," Simon said. Keeping in mind Johnston's emphasis on simplicity and believability, Simon focused on a clean outline with staggered engines and an organically shaped cockpit area. The massive Hydra Bomber proved a difficult undertaking, even for a seasoned veteran like Simon. "That vehicle was the toughest to model for me in 3D," Simon said. "The subtleties of aircraft design only alarm you when you actually have to do it. I thought I cracked it when I started pulling the wing tips more and more down, creating a negative V in front view. Flying wings don't photograph well, only in very few views. The trick then was to drag its wingtips down as much as I could, and finally it got a silhouette."

